

CHAPTER 7

Claude On Your Computer

From conversations to projects

What to do	How to do it	Why it matters
Create a project	New project → name it → connect a folder	Gives Claude focused context instead of everything at once
Set project instructions	Write rules in the project settings	Claude follows project-specific guidelines automatically
Work with files	Ask Claude to read, summarize, or create files in your folder	Output goes directly to your computer, not just the chat
Schedule a task	"Create a scheduled task that runs every [time/day]"	Claude works on its own schedule, not just when you ask
Explore plugins	Browse available plugins in settings	Extends what Claude can connect to and automate

Setting Up Project Instructions

This project is [what it is]. The audience is [who]. Use [tone]. The key files are [list]. The goal is [what we're trying to accomplish]. [Any specific rules – formatting, vocabulary, constraints].

Setting Up a Scheduled Task

Create a scheduled task that runs every [morning at 7am / Monday at 9am / Friday at 5pm]. Each time it runs, [what you want it to do – review files, summarize progress, check deadlines, build a report]. Keep it [length – one paragraph, one page, a bullet list].

The Progression

Conversations → Projects → Scheduled tasks → Plugins. Each step gives Claude more context and more autonomy. Start with a project. Add a scheduled task when you're ready. Explore plugins when you want Claude to reach beyond your files.

*This reference card is a companion to Chapter 7 of Creating with Claude by Chris Thatcher.
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